

100 YEAR HISTORY WALK – PRIMARY SCHOOL



As the town of Petersburg grew the need for a school was apparent.

The Union Church was leased by the education board, and an official school was opened in 1881.

The school was closed in April as the school master had disappeared. He had been seen in the neighbourhood, but it was reported that he was wondering around in a deranged state of mind. The council had been asked to appoint another as soon as possible. The school master was replaced by headmistress Miss Ellen J Arnold. The average attendance was less than fifty, with eighty-six school age children living within 3 ½ miles of the town.



Evening Journal
Wednesday 20 April

PETERSBURG, April 18.
Our school is closed at present, the school-master having disappeared and shows no sign of returning, he has been heard of in the neighborhood, but as far as I hear no one has taken any trouble about him although it is rumoured that he is wandering about in a deranged state of mind. The Council have been communicated with and the appointment of another master asked.

Union Church
Photo - State Library of SA – Peterborough Collection Image B 61759

The church was proven to be too small for the number of children who were attending so the town residents lobbied to have a school built.

A public meeting was held on 29th October 1881 to discuss the wants of the town.

- *An animated discussion ensued as to whether the site for the school was central enough. It was argued that the site was situated on high ground and in a healthy position and they had to look to the health of their children above all. It was estimated that there were now around eighty children who could attend school. The average attendance was between forty-five and fifty, and the old building could not possibly accommodate any more than already attended.*

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The government was spending nearly £3,000 on buildings including a new school, post office and police station and cells. £1,200 was for the new school which could accommodate eighty students, £850 for the police station and cells and £750 for the post office and telegraph station. The Board of Advice for the district has settled on allotments 241, 242, 243, and 244 in Petersburg North for the school. This land was purchased from Mr Rohde for £50.

Tenders for the government school at Petersburg were called for by Monday 9th May and Messrs. G. & W. Sara and Duncan's tender of £1098-12 was accepted on 23rd May. Sara & Duncan of Kooringa also built the railway station in 1880.

*Adelaide Observer
Saturday 10 June 1882*

Architect-in-Chief's Department.—Erection of a school and residence at Petersburg, G. & W. Sara and Dunstan, £1,098 12s.

The new Petersburg State School and a four roomed residence was completed in December 1882 and following a final inspection in March, Mr Inglis the head teacher and his students were able to move into the school building. The school had a capacity for 80 children.



*Petersburg State School - 1883
Photo – Peterborough Library History Room*

The enrolments of the state school had been around one hundred for the past four years and in 1887 they had increased to 150 pupils. Many cases of ophthalmia were reported and this had kept the attendance down to about 50. Mr Inglis, Mr Hardy and Miss Inglis (sewing and fancy work) had their hands full when all attended.

By 1891 the town population had increased and there were complaints made about the inadequate accommodation at the state school, as the attendance greatly exceeded the number of scholars the school could hold. The school year opened at the end of January with Mr D O'Leary, late of Georgetown as head teacher.

The Petersburg Council inspected the conditions at the state school. The school was originally built for 80 students and there were now nearly double that attending.

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With the additions to the Petersburg State School still not forthcoming the increasing population of the town made the accommodation even more cramped. Many lessons were held outside, and sanitation was very low.

The overcrowded school had not had its promised additions, and in November 1891, the Petersburg Council decided to again communicate with the Minister of Education to try to resolve the matter.

The government agreed to arrange for a room to be used by the school to accommodate the children due to the overcrowding at the school. The council decided that the school could have use of the town hall for school purposes in the daytime.

Finally, by January 1892 the enlargement of the school was in progress, and the Education Department had rented a three-roomed house adjoining the school, for use until the additions were completed, rather than using the town hall. The additions of two classrooms which had progressed slowly would increase the capacity of students from 80 to 200.

The enlargements at the school had finally been finished and a building with two new classrooms had been added. The original room and teacher's residence had not been repaired or improved since its erection and was still in a terrible state.

Although the school had been enlarged the outhouse had not.

The sanitary conditions of the outbuildings at the state school were still unacceptable in 1893. The attendance at the school had now reached 180 and they had been waiting for nearly two years for the promised enlargement.

THE PETERSBURG SCHOOL.

Petersburg, September 9.
 In reference to statements in "Hansard" it should be known that the Petersburg school-building at the outside has accommodation for only eighty children, whilst 122 were present to-day. On the roll there are 147, or nearly twice the number for which the school was built. The average attendance during July and August was 100 per day. The size of the building is 36 ft. by 20 ft. It is felt that in view of the leisurely manner in which the plans are being prepared that the summer will be over before any additions are completed.

Adelaide Observer
 Friday 12 September 1891

PETERSBURG, November 17.
 The apparently never-ending delay in proceeding with the long-talked-of additions to the State school was discussed at a meeting of the Town Council held last night, and it was resolved to again communicate with the Minister of Education and endeavor to induce him to visit the school personally. Many parents are now keeping their children away. The heat yesterday was intense.

The Express and Telegraph
 Tuesday 17 November 1891

SANITARY MATTERS AT THE SCHOOL.—The Central Board has directed the attention of of the local authorities to the unsanitary condition of the outbuildings at the State School and the facts disclosed reflect the utmost discredit on the Education Department. No increase in this accommodation has been made since the time when the attendance roll numbered 25—it has now reached 180. In addition to this, there seems little doubt but the tank from which the supply of water is drawn from the school, is contaminated from its proximity to the foul cess-pits. For some time past sickness amongst children has been unusually prevalent and it seems very probable that the disgraceful state of affairs at the school is largely to be blamed for this. The matter will be referred to more fully next week.

Petersburg Times
 Friday 20 January 1893

Petersburg State School 1892
Peterborough Library History Room



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Even with the additional building several years ago the conditions at the state school had not improved with overcrowding a major issue. The school buildings could accommodate 200 students and there were almost 300 enrolled. There were only three teaching staff at the school as the fourth teacher had left and was not replaced. Many parents were refusing to send their children as they feared their children's health was in danger.

Dr Stevenson submitted a report on the Government School. According to the report *"the school was overcrowded and the old part of the building badly ventilated, the air in the latter, on being tested showing 12 parts per 1000 of carbolic acid gas. The teachers and children frequently complained of headache and lassitude, which the Doctor altogether attributed to the crowded and unhealthy condition of the building."* -Petersburg Times Friday 14 September 1894

After many complaints at the overcrowding of the state school, tenders had finally been called for the erection of two additional classrooms in January 1897. The enrolments were about 430 students, and the accommodation was for about 250.

The long-awaited additions to the Petersburg State School had been completed and were opened on Monday 7th September 1897.

PETERSBURG SCHOOL.

PETERSBURG, September 6.—A memorial was handed yesterday by the members of the local schoolboard of advice to Mr. L. O'Loughlin, M.P., for presentation to the Minister of Education, praying for increased accommodation at the Petersburg State school. The memorial was signed by nearly 200 residents. Unless some improvement is effected as the warm weather comes on many will decline to send their children to school. The building has accommodation for 200 children, whereas the average attendance is over 200. In many instances very young children have to walk miles into the town to school, and are then forced to remain standing all day. A recent report by the local health officer (Dr. Stevenson) shows the school to be in an unhealthy condition.

South Australian Chronicle
Friday 8 September 1894

THE PETERSBURG SCHOOL.

PETERSBURG, October 5.—The mayor to-day inspected the State school, which continues as crowded and badly ventilated as ever. Forms and desks made for half a dozen children had to accommodate eight or nine, and a number were standing. For some time a large percentage had been absent on account of sickness (which is largely attributed by the local medical officer of health to the insanitary conditions at the school), otherwise things would be worse. A number of parents who decline to see their children's health endangered are refusing to send their children to school at all, and in some cases have challenged the local school board of advice to initiate a prosecution against them. It is suggested that the parents should combine and decline to send their children to school after a certain date until more accommodation is provided. As local feeling is very strong it is not improbable that this will be carried out. Outside the school things are equally bad. The water supply would be inadequate for a two-roomed cottage, the playground is absurdly small, and the fence surrounding it is tumbling to pieces. The teaching staff is three to nearly 300 children. Until recently there were four, but one has left and has not been replaced.

South Australian Chronicle
Friday 13 October 1894

PETERSBURG STATE SCHOOL.—The additions to the school which for some time have been in progress, are now complete, and reflect every credit on the contractors, Messrs Tuck Brothers, of Terowie. The new portion, which will provide accommodation for 160 additional scholars, will be opened on Monday next. The rooms are fitted with the latest improvements as regards furniture, which has been provided by the department in no niggardly fashion. The additions include a gallery and an extra porch, whilst the general improvements in the appearance of the building is most marked. The present average attendance is over 300, the teaching staff comprising—Mr D. O'Leary (head teacher), Mr. H. McNicol, Misses Clarke and McMahon, Mr Brady and Miss O'Leary.

Petersburg Times
Friday 10 September 1897



Petersburg State School
Photo – Lionel Noble Collection

In 1898 a roomy play shed had been erected at the state school by Messrs Tuck Bros. This and the other additions made the previous year had greatly improved the accommodation at the school.

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By the end of 1900 there were over 420 children enrolled at the school, with 411 sitting the public exam. Over 200 people attended a visitors day at the public school on Friday 12 October, and it was suggested to hold future open days in the town hall, to allow better viewing of the children's exhibits.

The Mayor Mr Thomas Henry Chinner in his speak gave the boys of the school some very wise advice on not taking up cigarette smoking, and to be courteous and gentlemanly in their behaviour.

His Worship the Mayor (T. H. Chinner, Esq.) presided, and said—In the first place I cannot help saying that we, as parents and children, have much to thank our Government for. Our present system of education is second to none in the world; it offers to every child the opportunity of getting an education which will enable him to fill almost any position in this life, and in addition to this the Government now offers to the State schools a scholarship which can be competed for by every scholar who desires it, which when won it entitles the boy or girl to three years' training at any of the colleges, and the Government further offers to the successful candidate a position at the School of Mines with some £30 or £40 wherewith to meet expenses. To the boys especially I would give a word of warning—do not take up cigarette smoking! If you are to be strong mentally you must not take up this habit. I have been in the shops and noticed small boys buying cigarettes. If young people smoke cigarettes and cigars they will destroy their nervous system before it is fully formed, and render themselves liable to neuralgia and nervous diseases of the brain, which will certainly destroy their mental force, therefore if you would win this scholarship to which I just referred you must have a strong mental force, which has not become impaired by the use of tobacco, which not only destroys the brain, but is calculated to stunt the physical growth of the body. I refer with great pleasure and interest to the splendid manual work, and congratulate you upon your excellent achievements in this branch of your work—instead of the unsightly mud work and the children being covered with white clay. We now see useful brushes equal to anything made by experienced workmen, bookbinding, fretwork and fancy wire work, which reflects great credit alike upon your teachers and yourselves. In conclusion let me say to all boys, be courteous and gentlemanly in your behaviour; such deportment in your characters will be the golden key which will open to you the doors of many a good situation in after life which otherwise would be barred to you. It is a treat to meet boys in this age of slang who will call things by their right names. Avoid the use of slang and bad language and always respect your seniors. I congratulate you upon your successful examination, and in doing so point out the fact that Mr. McAloney has but had you in hand for some nine months, with such grand results as we now see before us. On behalf of the town I wish to say that we are proud of our school, the head master and his staff, and in the future can confidently look forward to still greater success.

Petersburg Times
Friday 19 October 1900

The visit of the Duke and Duchess of Cornwall and York to Australia in May 1901 saw the state school involved with a country wide ceremony of hoisting the Union Jack.

Hoisting the Flag.

THE CEREMONY AT PETERSBURG STATE SCHOOL.

The ceremony of hoisting the Union Jack was carried out at many of the State Schools in South Australia on Tuesday, 14th inst., and the children of the above school performed this unique act simultaneously with the rest of the school children of the Commonwealth. Precisely at 12.15 p.m., in accordance with arrangements previously made, every telegraph office key in the province ceased to work, and for five minutes the lines throughout the length and breadth of the State were clear. At 12.20 the Duchess of Cornwall and York touched the key in Melbourne, the influence of which traversed the wires throughout the Commonwealth and gave the time for the word "Hoist!" to be transmitted along all the lines to every station in the Commonwealth. Preparatory arrangements for the successful performance of this act had been made at the local school, and on the election of the children attending Miss Evelyn Woodward was chosen to pull the flag aloft. By 12.15 a fair number of residents of the town had assembled, at the invitation of Mr. R. S. McAloney, the head teacher, to witness the proceedings. An apology was received from Mr. Geo. Prime, and

the only other member of the Board of Advice present was Dr. J. R. Stevenson. The children were marched out, class by class, and took their places in front of the school building, and it was an impressive sight to see 480 healthy boys and girls, under the guidance of their teachers, stand to "attention." Upon the receipt of the word at the post-office, the genial and popular postmaster, Mr. J. A. Bowley, fired two gun shots as a note of warning, which was heard distinctly at the school, and instantly Miss Woodward hoisted the flag. Under the supervision of Mr. Coles, the children heartily sang the "National Anthem."

His Worship the Mayor (G. W. Halcombe, Esq.) then addressed the gathering. He said he was present, at the invitation of Mr. McAloney, to witness the auspicious ceremony, and that it had been arranged at a given time throughout all the States of the Commonwealth that a similar ceremony should be performed; the time 20 minutes past 12 corresponded with 50 minutes past 12 in Melbourne. At that hour the Duchess of Cornwall touched an electric key at the Melbourne Exhibition and gave the signal for hoisting the flag right through the Commonwealth, so that all over Australia at that moment the school children were doing as they were then doing. The Mayor then called for

three cheers for the King which met with a hearty response, and three equally hearty ones were given for the Duke and Duchess of Cornwall and York.

The Rev. J. Murray said the event was a most unique one—it had never occurred before and could never happen again. He advised the children to look upon their school days as the time when they were acquiring knowledge that would be of infinite benefit to them in the future. They were living under the freest constitution on earth, and the most pleasing feature to him was that every boy present might aspire to be a member of the Federal Parliament. Those gentlemen who were now members of the Government and of the Houses of Parliament were once school boys like themselves and possibly never expected to be where they were that day, and every boy by diligence in his studies was being grounded in the fundamentals that would equip him for any position. He trusted that all the children would be loyal subjects of the king, and diligently embrace the opportunities now given them. He congratulated Mr. McAloney and his staff on the success of the day's proceedings.

Three hearty cheers were then given by the children for the teachers, and the gathering dispersed.

A splendid photograph of the assemblage was taken by Mr. Marchant.

Petersburg Times
Friday 17 May 1901

100 YEAR HISTORY WALK – PRIMARY SCHOOL

It was announced in December 1906 that continuation classes were to be established at Petersburg, Gawler, Moonta, Kapunda, Mount Gambier, Kadina and Port Pirie. Mr J Bills from the State School received a wire directing him to report to headquarters to test his qualifications to take charge in the projected continuation school. Forty pupils had signified their intention of attending.

An open day was held at the Petersburg State School on Friday 4th October 1907 with a large number of parents and friends attending. An splendid exhibition of fancy and other work was on view and unstinted praise was given for the children and teachers alike. There were 484 students enrolled and 341 of these undertook exams. 304 of these students were promoted, 33 of whom from the 6th Class, and it was hoped will qualify for the continuation class at the end of the year. The establishment of the continuation class, the formation of the school band and cadet corps were all great additions to the school. New classrooms were being built to accommodate the upper classes and would relieve the pressure of much needed accommodation.

After an eight year aggregation the additions to the state school of two classrooms and a new teacher's residence had been completed in 1908. The school had 480 children on the roll and even with the new accommodation the school was almost taxed to its full capacity. The additions were declared open by the Treasurer (Hon AH Peake) accompanied by the Commissioner of Crown Lands and members for the district. The two new rooms were for the continuation class which would be known as a district high school.

The old head teachers house had been demolished after the new one was built.



*Original Petersburg State School building built in 1883 with the additional two classrooms for the High school class and new teachers house built in 1908
Photo – Lionel Noble Collection*

An outbreak of measles in 1910 saw 170 students out of 432 absent at one time. The school had had several improvements, such as the decoration of the walls and the removal of window frosting, to make the rooms light and bright. The school band had been reformed and was hoping to purchase a side drum. Several wants were the renovation of the infant room piano, and establishing a school library, of which parents were invited to contribute books. It was hoped to establish a savings bank at the school for the children from the third grade up to deposit their pennies in.

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At the suggestion of the Prime Minister, Australia Day was to be celebrated on 30 July 1915, to raise a fund to provide comfort and nursing assistance for the men fighting at the front in the war.

Petersburg chose to celebrate over two days: Friday 30th and Saturday 31st July. On Friday a pageant headed by the mounted police and brass band, followed by the mayor, councillors, cadets and over 600 schoolchildren, along with the Petersburg State School Fife and Drum Band started the proceedings. This was followed by an auction of goods for the Red Cross Society in the Auction Mart. Pictures were shown in the town hall and the ladies supplied afternoon tea in the hall annexe and sweets in the town clerk's office.

The celebrations continued on Saturday with a procession starting from the loco shed and wound its way to the showgrounds. All money raised was to be given to the Wounded Soldiers Fund in South Australia.

In 1916 the school age limit had been changed and children between the age of six and fourteen were required to attend. Children under the age of 14 received free tuition.

ANZAC day was celebrated at the Public School for the first time on Thursday 20 April 1916.

AT THE SCHOOL.

Anzac Day was celebrated at the Public School, Petersburg, on Thursday, April 20, under favourable conditions, and great enthusiasm was shown. There was a large attendance of parents and the public. Under the direction of the headmaster (Mr. W. Luke), the children, headed by the school band, marched around the flag pole, saluted the Union Jack, and formed up into a square. The National Anthem was sung with great vigour. Mr. W. Luke gave a vigorous patriotic address on the Australian soldiers and the Empire, and was frequently applauded. The upper

classes followed with a spirited recitation. Appropriate addresses were delivered by the Mayor (Mr. A. Jamieson), the Bishop of Willochra (Dr. G. White), Inspector J. Fairweather, Mr. J. W. Bowering (late chairman of School Board of Advice), and Rev. H. C. Farley. Inspector Fairweather proposed, and Mr. Jenkins (assistant in-charge of the High School) seconded a vote of thanks to the visitors, which was carried by acclamation. Mr. W. Luke and Lieut. G. W. Noden then presented to the Mayor Sgts. Watson and Murrell and Pte. Crawford, returned soldiers from Gallipoli. As each man was received

ringing cheers were given by the children. Inspector Fairweather mentioned in his remarks that if the military authorities wanted a good recruiting officer, they would jump at the chance to secure Mr. W. Luke's services; but the Government could not do without such a strong man in the Public School at Petersburg. The whole ceremony was of a most impressive character, and was solemnly and earnestly entered into by the children and visitors, many being visibly affected. The ceremony concluded with the playing of the Dead March by the school band and the playing of the Last Post by Master H. Taylor.

*Petersburg Times
Friday 5 May 1916*

The playground at the public school had been in unusable since the building of the drain in 1915 and the children had not been able to use it. The Minister for Education (Hon Mr Harvey) visited the school on Wednesday 23rd October 1918 and he stated that he would find funds to rectify the problem. There was no drainage and the ground was often no more than just slush and mud.

The school committee also asked about having shorthand and typewriting taught at the high school, as scholars from the school had no chance to enter the examination for the clerical division of the railways unless they were conversant with those subjects.

18 new cases of influenza had been reported by the medical officers to the Local Board of Health in the past 3 days since Saturday 5th April 1919. The public school had been closed to use as a temporary hospital by Board. A hospital had been set up at the school and six patients were removed there on the morning of Tuesday 8th April. Twenty beds had been provided and more patients would be admitted as soon as arrangements were complete. Dr Arnold reported that all the cases were mild so far. The mayoress, with a band of willing women workers, had prepared a huge parcel of necessities for the hospital, and were busy making more. St Joseph's School and the Sunday schools were all closed as a precaution.

The Board of Health closed the temporary hospital at the public school on 6th May as the town was free of influenza. The school was disinfected and lessons restarted on 13th May.

100 YEAR HISTORY WALK – PRIMARY SCHOOL

The Hon LL Hill (Minister for Education), the Director of Education, the Superintendent of Primary Education and the Federal and State Members of Parliament visited Peterborough and were tendered a civic reception by the corporation on Friday 27th March 1924. A public address in the town hall in the evening was attended by a large number of the public. On Saturday morning the visitors inspected the site of the new high school and the remodelling of the primary school.

The remodelling of the state school had been given the go ahead and arrangements had been made by the Education Department to temporarily transfer the high school students to the Methodist Sunday School Hall where they would rent the hall and two classrooms in 1926.

Peterborough School

It is proposed to remodel the Peterborough Public School after the high school has been completed, the Hon. L. L. Hill (Minister of Education) told Mr. A. R. G. Hawke in the Assembly today.

The News
Wednesday 17 December 1924

The Times and Northern Advertiser
Friday 22 January 1927

Peterborough Primary School.

The monthly meeting of the School Committee was held at the Head Teacher's residence on Thursday evening last. There were present Rev. E. Smith (chairman), Mrs. Lewis, Messrs J. A. Wright (Secretary), Sumner H. Koch and A. G. Tregenza. Apologies for non attendance were received from Messrs Thos. Hunter and Philp.

Accounts passed for payment included £3 14/9 for white-washing out houses and repairs to gutters, 9/6 for repairs to tank, £2 2/ for renovating the piano.

Head Teacher was authorised to purchase a new football for Grade IV, at the expense of the Committee.

Letter was received from the Town Clerk intimating that the Works Committee had been instructed to inspect "The Flat," and given power to proceed with the leveling of the same and to remove the existing fence. Com-

mittee expressed the hope that this necessary work would be undertaken at an early date.

Prices having been received for water troughing the matter of the erection of increased washing accommodation for the children was left in the hands of Mr. Koch to finalise.

In the matter of suitable bicycle accommodation, Secretary reported that he was negotiating for a job lot of timber (which was in splendid condition) and immediately this was available a "working bee" would make the necessary provision for the children's bicycles.

Blackboards for the use of Grades 1 and 2 had been ordered, but were not yet to hand and the Secretary undertook to again write the Education Department in reference to them.

Chairman reported that, with Mr. Koch and the Head Teacher, he had conducted Mr. Carter, M.P., through the school Building. The member expressed himself as being fully seized with the urgency of remodelling, and

promised, on behalf of himself and colleagues, to do his utmost to have the work started at an early date.

On Saturday afternoon last a party of 24 boys and 20 girls from the Primary School journeyed in lorries and car to Terowie, where they engaged the local Higher Primary boys and girls in games of football and basketball.

The football match resulted in a win for the Terowie exponents of the game by 7.7 to 3.2. They thus avenged their defeat at the hands of the Peterborough lads a month ago.

The two basketball games were exceptionally well contested, Terowie winning one game (12-7) and Peterborough the other (7-6). The Peterborough players are particularly grateful to Mr. Koch for giving up his afternoon and in providing a lorry (and, it is rumored, meat pies also!) The girls were safely conveyed over the rough roads by Mr. Mildren.

On Saturday games will be played against Jamestown Primary School at Peterborough.

The Times and Northern Advertiser
Friday 24 June 1927

Primary School

The question of re-modelling the school building was again discussed. The Secretary (Mr Wright) reviewed the correspondence on the subject for several years past and it was finally decided to invite the new members for the district to visit the school at an early date with a view to having this long over-due work done during the next financial year.

In respect to the Flat opposite the school, it was decided that an endeavor should be made to create this into an up-to-date Children's Playground. With this object in view it was resolved to hold a concert for the purpose of raising part of the necessary funds. In the meantime a letter was to be written to the Corporation, asking that the grader should be worked over the grounds in order to level it up as much as possible. Until this is

done it is not advisable to do anything in the way of erecting seesaws or swings or laying down tennis courts or cricket pitches.

Another important matter dealt with was the provision of extra washing conveniences for the children. At present one small trough, 8 ft. long, is the only accommodation provided for 500 children. It was resolved that, as a first step, another trough be provided adjoining the underground tank.

A school fete organised by the Mother's Association which had recently been established, was held in 1928 to raise money to improve the grounds at the school to erect swings and to make an ideal playground for the children. Building a bike shed was also mentioned.

100 YEAR HISTORY WALK – PRIMARY SCHOOL

Finally the long awaited improvements were completed and classrooms were renovated. Mr RL Davies of Jamestown had been accepted by the government for the tender of repairs and renovations of the school in March 1929.

Kingsley Buzza (five and a half year old son of Mr David Buzza, council employee) was killed after he crossed over the footbridge over the drain near the school on 28th June 1929 and was run over by a bakers cart. His neck was broken in the collision and was dead on arriving at the hospital.

After verification of Council's legal authority it was decided to close the dangerous road in front of the Primary School.

In 1930 the Commissioner of Highways had confirmed that his department would bear half costs of erecting a bridge over the drain on Government Road and would be prepared to loan the Council the other half on terms of three or five years at 6 per cent. The Council had been trying to get the District Council of Yongala to pay a half of their portion of the bridge as one side of Government Road was in their district. The Government Road was the only road crossing the drain that did not have a bridge and since the closing of the road in front of the school the Council felt it was a Government matter entirely.

In 1930 there was an enrolment of 477 students at the Primary School.

Visiting day was held at the primary school on Friday 11 December 1931 and included sports, a parade of decorated vehicles and bicycles, marching and a pet show. The pet show became an annual event, running well into at least the 1990s.

At the pet show held by the Mother's Association on the primary school grounds on Saturday 27th April 1935, so numerous were the entries in the dog section it appeared that every dog in the town had been bought to the school. The school fife and drum band marched through the streets prior to the opening ceremony, which was performed by Mrs SD Jones (president of the association). A fancy dress parade was held and all sections of the pet show were represented.

Minister for Education (Mr Jeffries), Director of Education (Mr Adey) along with Messrs Jenkins, Melrose and McDonald (MPs) inspected the primary school on Friday 22nd February 1935 and met with the school committee. A deputation asked for increased accomodation and pointed out that repairs were urgently needed to the grounds.

The Minister said that of the two proposals he preferred separate rooms for the infants as against the building of the stories. Further accommodation was essential. The matter would be gone into carefully. The Advertiser – Saturday 23rd February 1935.

CHILD'S NECK BROKEN

RUN OVER ON WAY TO SCHOOL

Peterborough, June 28.
On his way to school this morning, Kingsley Buzza, aged six, had just crossed a small footbridge over a drain, in front of the primary school, when he was run over by a baker's cart. The headmaster (Mr. L. C. Nock) took the lad to the hospital but he was dead on arrival. In addition to other serious injuries the boy's neck was broken. The road, which runs between the drain and the school, is very dangerous, and many complaints about it have been made to the council.

Chronicle
Thursday 4th July 1929

Mr. G. H. Koch, chairman of the School Committee, invited Mr. S. D. Jones, Mayor of Peterborough, to open the proceedings, which included a splendid pet show, after which Councillor Lewis presented the cup donated by him to the captain of the Primary School Cricket Club, Ron Hoffmann. Last year the cup was won by the St. Joseph's Cricket Club, so that now each school has one win. Ron Hoffmann expressed thanks to Councillor Lewis. The Rev. Father Nesdale congratulated the Primary School boys on their fine win, and expressed pleasure at the improvement shown by the members of both teams. Mr. J. Casey, who kindly donated a gold medal to the player securing the highest batting average, handed his medal to Bert Cave, of the Primary School, at the same time expressing pleasure at the keenness of the competition, for the top batting averages were separated by small margins.

Mr. A. R. M. Nancarrow (head teacher) expressed thanks to Councillor Lewis for the splendid support and interest manifested by him in encouraging cricket among the boys; also to Mr. J. Casey for the very fine medal donated by him.

Those present witnessed a parade of decorated vehicles and bicycles, after which a marching competition between Grades 3, 4, 5, 6, and 7 was enjoyed. This was judged by His Worship the Mayor and Councillor N. Bowering.

Addresses were then given by Mr. J. Critchley, M.P., Mr. E. George, M.P., and Councillor Bowering, after which the children marched to the sports ground where a programme of sports was gone through.

Afternoon tea was supplied by the Mothers' Association, with Mrs. S. D. Jones as president, and Mrs. J. Bowden as secretary. They were ably assisted by a band of splendid workers. The crockery was kindly lent by Mr. Alex. Dickson.

The cake stall was in charge of Mesdames Flavel, Lamb and Cave, supported by Mr. L. Nenke. Other stalls were:—Sweets stall—Misses Taylor and Nobel; ice cream—Misses Smith and White, supported by the Laura Ice Cream Coy.; cool drinks, Miss Crowhurst, supported by Mrs. Standish and Mr. R. Goudie.

The Times and Northern Advertiser
Friday 18 December 1931

100 YEAR HISTORY WALK – PRIMARY SCHOOL

The new Infant's classroom at the Primary School was opened by the Minister of Education (Mr CS Jeffries), on Friday 21st August. The building consisted of a large hall, divided into two classrooms by folding doors, with another classroom, large enclosed veradah and broom room on the north side. Afternoon tea for the official party was supplies by the Mothers' Association.

Minister of Education Opens New Infants' School at Peterborough.

Although what children had thought the drudgery at school had passed, it all had had its purpose in preparing the children for the great crisis in life, said the Minister of Education (Mr. C. S. Jeffries) in opening the new infant class rooms at Peterborough on Friday afternoon, and he illustrated his remarks with the story of Ben Hur, his slavery and triumphant chariot race. He also said that the fact that the State spent about one tenth of it's revenue on education, should impress upon children and parents the importance attached to the present day child, who is the citizen of the future.

The Minister was accompanied by Dr. C. Fenner (Acting Director), L. G. Canst (Inspector), Hon. G. F. Jenkins, Messrs. A. D. McDonald and A. J. Melrose (Members Burra Burra), the Mayor of Peterborough (S. D. Jones, Esq. J.P.), Messrs. G. H. Koch (acting Chairman School Committee), L. Walker (Secretary), the Mayoress (Mrs. Jones), and Mr. and Mrs. R. S. Love (headmaster & wife), Miss V. M. Morris (infant mistress), and the Staff of the School. Mr. H. Pomery, one of the original pupils in the first school in Peterborough, was present and at the request of the Minister was seated on the dais, with the official party.

The infants, in festive array, formed a guard of honor and afterwards lined up in front of the dais and submitted items at intervals. The upper grade girls also submitted a rhythm item. Proceedings opened with the "Song of Australia" by the full school.

Mr. Koch welcomed the Minister and party and said it was a red letter day for the children, parents and committee. They were very happy to have their big City friends present, who had been very sympathetic in their problems and had been instrumental in bringing about the culmination of their hopes. The matter had long been delayed, but was now an accomplished fact and reflected great credit on their old secretary (Mr. R. J. Bowden), who worked very hard and continuously to bring about the establishment of a separate infants school.

Mr. Jeffries received a hearty reception and thanked the committee for their invitation to open the new building and participate in their memorable occasion. Only 18

months ago he had visited the schools requiring alterations and it was evident that an infants school was required at Peterborough and he thought it quick work to be able to open the building that day. A number wanted improvements and the most urgent had to be taken first, hence others had preceded this one and others had yet to be attended to. He congratulated the parents and children on the accomplishment. He briefly reviewed the history of the local school, which commenced in 1881 in a storeroom (behind what was now known as McKenzie's Red Store, Main Street) with 96 children, of whom Mr. Pomery was one and Helen J. Arno'd was the first teacher. In 1882 a school and residence was built, at a cost of £1100, and William Johanning took charge; then followed Gilbert J. Inglis, 1883; Thomas McInerney, 1890; Daniel O'Leary, 1891; Robert S. McAloney, 1899; Adolph E. Mueller, 1906; James S. Gold, 1910; Richard Sutton, 1911; William J. Gunn, 1912; Thomas H. S. Nicolle, 1913; William Luke, 1915; Charles J. W. Mundy, 1918; Richmond T. Hitchcock, 1920; John Mitchell, 1921; Robert G. Alexander, 1923; Albert G. Tegenza, 1928; Leslie C. Nock, 1929; and Arthur R. (M. Nancarrow, 1931. Robt. S. Love took charge in 1932 and was still controlling it. With the continued progress of the town, the school had been enlarged several times and now embraces the first residence and the first continuation school, the new residence for the Head Master having been built on a separate allotment, on the west side of the school, and the High School removed to the southern portion of the town. Numerous outdoor improvements had been effected and now they had new grounds

100 YEAR HISTORY WALK – PRIMARY SCHOOL

and a new Infant School—surely an accomplishment. The majority of the head masters had passed to the great beyond but all had done well in the Department, as their successors and the assistants had done. Teachers were giving their lives to the cause of education and even sacrificed much of their own time for the best interests of the children. The School Committee and Mothers' Association had done much to improve the facilities and conditions, as was strongly in evidence that day as the results of the hard and consistent work of the late committee and their secretary. Their deepest thanks was due to them all for the part they had played in keeping the school abreast of the times.

They had the most modern school in the world and that was no exaggeration, as for its size, requirements, accommodation and equipment no better building could be found. Everything was the very latest, substantial building, modern lighting, ventilation, lofty roomy classrooms, beautiful playgrounds, in fact everything possible was incorporated in the best interests of the children. From £800,000 to one million was spent annually in education, which impressed upon them the importance the Government attached to the education of the future citizens. Mr. Jeffries told them the story of Ben Hur to show the value of the training grounds in school. He concluded by unlocking the door and declaring the building open (applause).

The Hon. G. F. Jenkins, in moving a vote of thanks to the Minister paid a great tribute to the old school committee, especially the energetic secretary (Mr. R. J. Bowden) who gave the Members no peace in pressing for improvements to the School. The people were indebted to the present Minister for the great interest he was

taking in schools and the children. There was hardly a week end, but he was out somewhere looking into school matters and he showed his sympathy in their problems in a practical way. The bonny, happy children present demonstrated the good work being done by education.

Mr. A. D. McDonald, in an appropriate speech, seconded the vote, which was carried with acclamation.

Dr. Fenner also delivered an address.

Mr. A. J. Melrose moved a vote of thanks to the Chairman, congratulated the old committee and secretary on the result of their hard work and consistent agitation.

His Worship the Mayor, in seconding, added his congratulations to the Committee and to the Minister and Government for having established an infants school at Peterborough. Many years of effort was now rewarded. On behalf of the Corporation and, as President of the High School Committee, he extended best wishes.

Mr. Koch suitably replied.

Proceedings concluded with the saluting of the Flag and the National Anthem, after which the building was inspected by the large gathering. It consists of a large hall, divided into two classrooms by folding doors, with another classroom, large enclosed verandah and broom room on the north side. The grounds are surrounded with a large iron fence and altogether the new school is an up-to-date and substantial addition to the Primary School.

The official party was entertained at afternoon tea by the Mothers' Association, headed by Mrs. McGlaughlan. Mrs. Millington catered for the young folk with a sweets and cake stall, in aid of her daughter's candidature in the Queen Competition.

*The Times and Northern Advertiser
Friday 28 August 1936*



*Infant Classroom - 1975
Photo – Lionel Noble Collection*

100 YEAR HISTORY WALK – PRIMARY SCHOOL

In 1937 the primary school sought council's permission to lay a cricket pitch on the school flat, which was the corporation's property. Permission was granted and metal was supplied for the construction of the pitch.

Ownership of the flat which was used as a playground by the primary school was given to the education department in 1939, by the council on the condition that it was fenced.

The Minister of Education (Mr Jeffries) and the Director of Education (Dr C Fenner) held a meeting in April 1940 with teaching staff and associated committees of the high school and primary school and surrounding schools with the view of establishing an area school. They explained that it would give better education facilities for the children from smaller schools in the area, and daily transport would be provided. This proposal was rejected.

Finally in October 1940 at the request of the council, Mr Siebers (Assistant Engineer) of the highway department inspected the very dangerous corner of Government Road and Bridges Street. The councils request for a bridge was granted and he recommended that a timber bridge be erected at this particular corner. £100 was granted for the construction of a wooden bridge, and construction started in July 1941.

The enrolment reached 522 in 1937 but during the war dropped to 265. The enrolment was at a high in 1956 with 600 students enrolled. There are now under 40 students at the school.

A library was finally opened at the school in December 1943. A photo of Mr GH (Heinie) Koch who had been a member of the school committee for 23 years and chairman for 16 was unveiled and proudly hung on the library wall.

The toilet block was upgraded in 1968 as the closure of several small schools in the area forced an issue that had been long overdue. This also highlighted the condition of the school with lack of heating and no cooling. It was recorded that the temperature in Mrs Clune's room to have reached 105° Celcius in February 1963.

A push to have the school upgraded saw a proposal from the education department to build a new administration and library block. This would also include a new staff room to replace the iron lean-to that staff had been using at the time.

An inspection of the school in 1971 by the Minister of Education, Mr H Hudson accompanied by the school committee, saw a very animated discussion on the needs of the school. The minister voiced his dismay at the conditions at the school and agreed that action would be taken when funds were available.

It was then suggested by the education department that the primary school be moved to the south side of the town, closer to the facilities at the high school rather than update the cramped, and untidy campus the school had become, with the additions of prefab classes over the years.



*Prefab classrooms with Infant Classroom and Junior Primary Playground - 1975
Photo – Lionel Noble Collection*

100 YEAR HISTORY WALK – PRIMARY SCHOOL

In November 1972 the school was inspected by the Public Works Standing Committee and approval was given for a rebuild of the school at a cost of \$430,000.

Plans of the makeover for the school showed converted stone buildings into open space classrooms, along with the addition of an administration block, library, activity room and additional classrooms. Not all were convinced that this was the right plan and many suggestions were discussed. Some of these ideas were incorporated into the design. The plans did not include air-conditioning which was one of the committees wants. This was later included.

In February 1974 renovations started at the primary school. Demolition of prefabricated classrooms and the principals house went ahead before the building of a new administration building and library, activity room and two open space units. The old original buildings were extensively renovated into 'open space' and air-conditioning was installed. Bakers house in Chinner Street remained and was used as a classroom during the building phase and then used as an extra area. The community used the house for meetings.

The official opening of the new building complex at the primary school was performed on Thursday 14 October as part of the Peterborough Centenary Celebrations.

The Peterborough Community Kindergarten was relocated to the building previously known as the 'infant' rooms at the northern end of the primary school in June 2005. A bathroom was added with small sized toilets and nappy changing facilities along with washing machine and drier.

The building was officially opened on Monday 8 August by Graham Gunn and Terry Sizer. Rural care services started in October 2005 replacing the previously known occasional care at the kindy. The kindy is now known as the Peterborough Community Preschool and Rural Care.



*Peterborough Preschool and Rural Care - 2026
Photo – Janet Fielding*



*Administration Building - 1975
Photo – Lionel Noble Collection*



*Classrooms near Victoria Street - 1976
Photo – Lionel Noble Collection*



*View from Victoria Street - 1976
Photo – Lionel Noble Collection*



Peterborough Primary School Administration Building - 2026
Photo – Janet Fielding

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